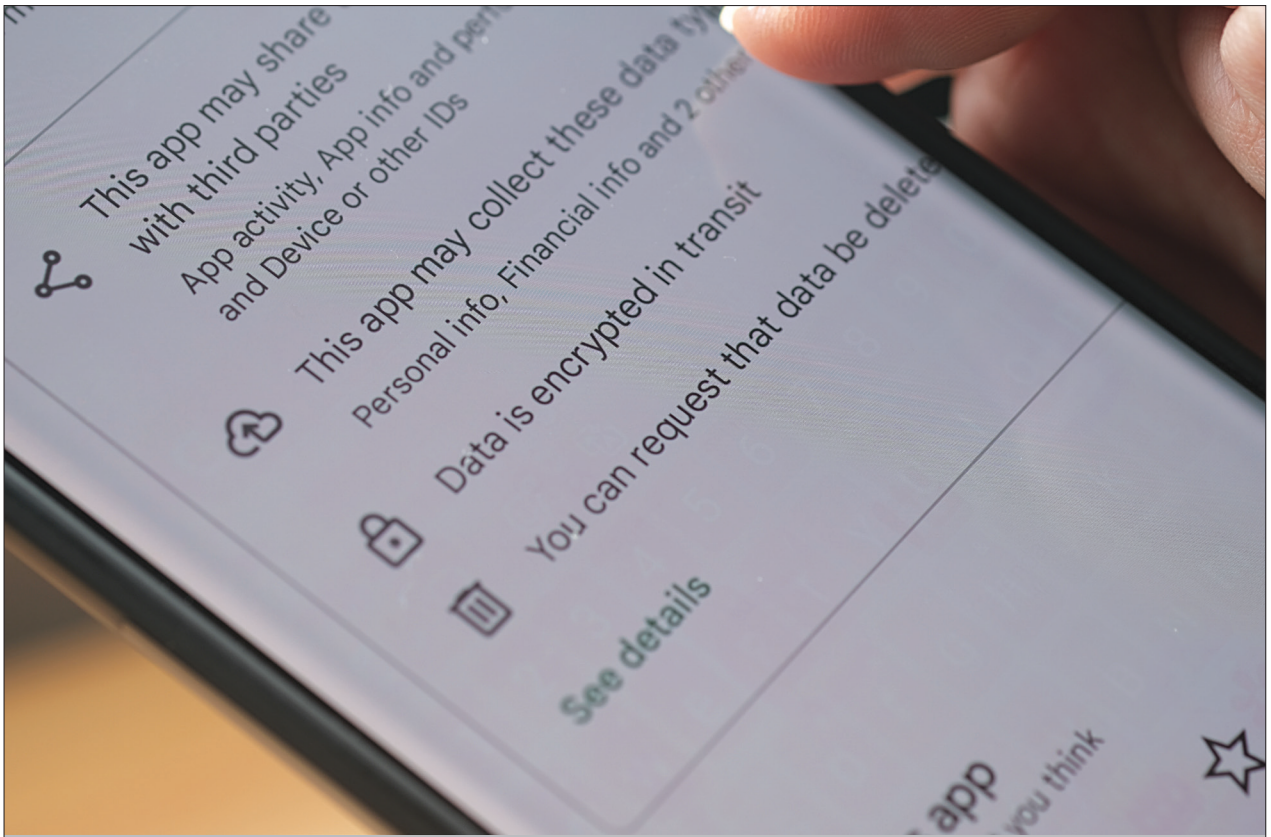




# Authentication and access control

Layered identity defences with strong credentials

In this chapter, we'll build a robust authentication and access-control posture for mobile devices. By the end, you'll understand how to orchestrate these layers into a seamless, user-friendly experience that resists compromise without frustrating legitimate access.

## Strong passwords and PINs

Effective authentication starts with robust "something you know" credentials. Mobile devices often use PINs or alphanumeric passwords.

### 1. Enforce complexity

- **iOS:** Settings → Face ID & Passcode → Change Passcode → Tap Passcode Options → Custom Alphanumeric Code.

- **Android:** Settings → Security → Screen lock → PIN → Use at least 6-8 digits; for alphanumeric, switch to Password.

### 2. Set lockout thresholds

- **iOS/Android:** After 10 failed attempts, automatically wipe device (optional for highly sensitive use).

### 3. Use unique credentials per device

- Avoid reusing PINs across personal and work profiles; treat each device as a separate security domain.

### 4. Rotate periodically

- Change PIN or password every 90 days; schedule a calendar reminder if needed.